Returns & Refunds Policy

Fictional Olist-style Commerce Operations | Policy ID: DEMO-RET-001 | Version: 1.0 | Effective: 1 January 2018

SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION DOCUMENT - NOT AN ACTUAL OLIST POLICY. All timelines, rules, and processes below are invented for testing retrieval, citations, and agent reasoning. They are not legal or operational advice.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy describes a fictional marketplace process for returns, refunds, damaged items, missing deliveries, and escalations. It applies to simulated orders placed through the demonstration commerce platform. It does not establish actual seller obligations or consumer rights. Applicable law would supersede any conflicting operational rule.

2. Standard return eligibility

A customer may request a standard return within **30 calendar days after confirmed delivery**. The product should be unused, complete, and packaged with its original accessories. The customer must provide an order reference and the reason for the request. A support agent records the request in the case management system.

A request submitted on day 30 is within the standard window. Requests submitted on day 31 or later require an exception review and are not automatically eligible.

3. Non-returnable items and exceptions

Personalized products, perishable goods, and opened hygiene-sealed products are excluded from discretionary returns in this synthetic policy. This exclusion does not prevent review of products that arrived damaged, defective, or materially different from the listing. Support must not automatically reject such defect reports based only on the product category.

4. Required evidence

For a standard return, collect order ID, delivery date, product ID, reason, and customer contact details. For damage claims, request photos of the item and external packaging where available. Missing photographs do not automatically close a case; an agent may request an alternative description or escalation.

5. Damaged or incorrect items

Customers are encouraged to report visible transit damage or a wrong item within **48 hours after delivery** to support faster investigation. The 48-hour reporting target is a service workflow target, not an absolute denial rule. Claims received later are reviewed on their merits.

For an incorrect item, support verifies the ordered SKU against the delivered SKU, then offers replacement or refund subject to inventory availability and investigation. For damage, support records the severity, photographs if available, and the shipping condition.

6. Refund method and timing

Approved refunds are issued to the **original payment method** whenever technically possible. After the return is received and inspected, the finance team aims to initiate the refund within **5 business days**. Bank or payment-provider posting times are outside the platform's control and may add several days.

If the original payment method cannot accept a refund, finance must verify an alternative method with the customer before proceeding. Support agents may not independently change refund destinations.

7. Return shipping costs

For verified defects, wrong items, or seller fulfillment errors, the seller bears the return shipping cost in this demonstration process. For discretionary returns of eligible non-defective items, the customer may be responsible for return shipping; the cost must be disclosed before the customer confirms the return.

8. Partial refunds

Partial refunds may be offered when the customer agrees to keep a product with a minor cosmetic issue. A support supervisor must approve partial refunds exceeding **20% of the item price**. The rationale and customer acceptance must be recorded in the case notes.

9. Missing or delayed delivery

If tracking shows a delivery delay, support first checks the carrier status and estimated arrival date. If an order is **7 calendar days beyond the promised delivery date** with no confirmed delivery, support opens a logistics investigation. A refund or replacement is considered after checking carrier evidence and seller response.

A shipment marked delivered but reported missing requires an address and proof-of-delivery review. Support should not state that a refund is guaranteed before the investigation concludes.

10. Escalation matrix

Situation	Owner	Target response
Standard eligible return	Support agent	2 business days
Damage or wrong item	Support specialist	1 business day
Refund >20% partial	Support supervisor	2 business days
Suspected fraud / payment issue	Risk and finance	3 business days
Unresolved case after 5 days	Operations manager	1 business day

11. Human approval and audit trail

The copilot may summarize policy rules, locate relevant passages, and draft a recommended action. It **must not issue refunds, change payment details, or contact customers without explicit human approval**. Approved actions require the approver identity, timestamp, order ID, decision reason, and evidence references to be written to the audit log.

12. Data handling

Support staff should use only the minimum customer data needed for a case. Payment card details must not be copied into support notes. Sensitive information should be masked before use in AI prompts, retrieval indexes, or analytics exports.

13. Example scenarios for retrieval testing

Scenario A - Return within window: A customer received a standard product 18 days ago and requests a discretionary return. The request may proceed to eligibility checks because it is within the 30-day window.

Scenario B - Damage reported late: A customer reports a cracked item 72 hours after delivery. The report misses the 48-hour service target, but the case must still be reviewed rather than automatically rejected.

Scenario C - Refund processing: A return was inspected and approved on Monday. Finance targets refund initiation within five business days; the bank may take longer to post the funds.

Scenario D - Missing delivery: A parcel is eight days past its promised delivery date, with no delivery confirmation. Support opens a logistics investigation before deciding on a replacement or refund.

Scenario E - Copilot action request: A user asks the AI to issue a refund immediately. The copilot may prepare an action proposal but must wait for an authorized human to approve execution.

14. Document governance

Document owner: Demonstration Customer Operations. Review frequency: Every six months in the fictional company. This version is intentionally static for repeatable evaluation. Future versions should be stored with an immutable version identifier so citations can identify the exact policy used.

15. Limitations

This document is invented exclusively for the Enterprise Decision & Action Copilot portfolio. The Olist public dataset contains transaction records and does not verify these fictional policies. Never represent a synthetic rule as an actual Olist company rule.